

Deal 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 5 2
♥ K J T 6 2
♦ 8 6 2
♣ J T 9

8
5 6
21

♠ A 8 4
♥ A 8 7 3
♦ T 9 5
♣ 7 5 2



♠ K Q J 9 6
♥ 4
♦ K Q J 7
♣ A K Q

♠ T 7 3
♥ Q 9 5
♦ A 4 3
♣ 8 6 4 3

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 1

2NT shows a balanced hand with 8+ points,
and when NORTH then supports ♠s

SOUTH makes a slam try.

SOUTH bids RKC Blackwood 4NT. NORTH
shows two Keycards (two Aces) and SOUTH
bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by South			

Deal 2

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 6 4 2
♥ A 9 6 3
♦ 8 6 5 2
♣ J 9

11
5 4
20

♠ K J
♥ Q J 8 5
♦ Q T 9 7
♣ Q 4 2



♠ A Q 7
♥ K T 7 4 2
♦ K J 3
♣ A K

♠ T 9 8 5 3
♥ -
♦ A 4
♣ T 8 7 6 5 3

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	5♥
All Pass			
5♥ by South			

.

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 2

NORTH has a decent Limit Raise, and SOUTH tries RKC Blackwood.

NORTH replies to the 4NT bid with 5

♦

, zero or three Keycards.

So which is it, zero or three?

Pretty simple - since SOUTH holds three Keycards himself NORTH can hardly have three also since there

are only five total. She must have zero and SOUTH signs off at 5

Deal 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ J 5
♥ A 6 3 2
♦ 8 5 4
♣ 8 6 4 2

17
5 2
16

♠ K T 7 4
♥ K Q J 8 4
♦ A 6
♣ A 3



♠ A Q 8 6 3 2
♥ 5
♦ K Q 7
♣ K Q 5

♠ 9
♥ T 9 7
♦ J T 9 3 2
♣ J T 9 7

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 3

NORTH jumps to 4♠, confident that SOUTH could make 10 tricks

even if he just has 6 points.

SOUTH knows he can make more and bids RKCB 4NT.

NORTH's 5



response shows zero or three Keycards.

So which is it? Zero or three?

NORTH bid much too strongly to have no Aces. SOUTH

bids a confident 6♠, knowing NORTH has either three Aces or two Aces plus the ♠K.

Deal 4

South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 8 4 3
♥ J 6 2
♦ K 9 3
♣ A 8 5

10
10 7
13

♠ A 7 5
♥ Q T 8 3
♦ A 8 5 4
♣ 9 2



♠ 6
♥ A K 9 7 5 4
♦ 6
♣ K Q J T 3

♠ K J T 9 2
♥ -
♦ Q J T 7 2
♣ 7 6 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♠	Pass	6 ♥
All Pass			
6 ♥ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 4

With eleven cards in the "round" suits SOUTH has a lot of playing strength. So when NORTH bids

a Limit Raise in



s SOUTH wants to know about Aces.

RKCBlackwood tells him that NORTH has two Aces plus the trump Queen, so SOUTH can see that 6



is practically a certainty.

Deal 5

South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 6 5
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ K Q J 9
♣ T 7

11
6 7
16

♠ Q J 7 3
♥ A J 5
♦ T 6 3 2
♣ K 4



♠ A K 9 8 4 2
♥ K Q T 6
♦ 8 4
♣ A

♠ T
♥ 3
♦ A 7 5
♣ Q J 9 8 6 5 3 2 ♦

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 5

SOUTH has interest in slam after she hears NORTH's Limit Raise.

BUT, she should not use Blackwood holding two quick losers in the

suit.

Instead she makes a Control showing bid of 4♣. (Not Gerber since it didn't follow a NT bid.)

NORTH cooperates by making a Control bid of 4



West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♣
Pass	4 ♥	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

.

SOUTH stops at 4 ♠ because neither partner controls



S.

Deal 6

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 5 4 2
♥ 4 3
♦ -
♣ T 9 7 5 3 2

17
5 5
13

♠ 6
♥ K Q 8 7 2
♦ A K 9 6 3
♣ K Q



♠ A J 7
♥ J 6
♦ Q J T 8 7
♣ A 6 4

♠ T 9 8 3
♥ A T 9 5
♦ 5 4 2
♣ J 8

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	2♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♠
Pass	6♦		
All Pass			
6♦ by South			

♦

.

If SOUTH had just one Key-card, NORTH would bid 5

♦

over the 5♣ reply.

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 6

NORTH decides it is unlikely that SOUTH is Aceless, so all he wants to know is the number of Aces SOUTH does have.

He invokes RKC Blackwood.

Since no trump suit has been agreed, SOUTH bids as if

♦

s, the

last-bid suit prior to 4NT is agreed. SOUTH has two Key-cards plus the trump Queen, so she bids 5♠.

NORTH bids 6

Deal 7

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ J T 9 5 3 2
 ♥ A T 5
 ♦ J 5 2
 ♣ 2

17
 6 4
 13

♠ 6
 ♥ K Q 8 7 2
 ♦ K Q
 ♣ A K 9 6 3



♠ K Q 7
 ♥ J 6
 ♦ A 6 4
 ♣ Q J T 8 7

♠ A 8 4
 ♥ 9 4 3
 ♦ T 9 8 7 3
 ♣ 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	2♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
All Pass			
5♣ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 7

This is the companion to Deal 6. The cards are the same except that the

♦

s and ♣s have been swapped.

Again, NORTH has no problem as long as SOUTH holds at least one Key-card.

When SOUTH responds 5♣, (showing one Key-card), NORTH can pass.

That's what happens here.

Deal 8

South Deals
None Vul

♠ T 4
♥ A 9 7 6
♦ 9 7 5
♣ T 7 6 3

16
4 3
17

♠ K Q J 8 7 5 2

♥ 4

♦ K 6

♣ A K 5



♠ A 9 6

♥ Q J T 3

♦ A Q J

♣ Q J 9

♠ 3

♥ K 8 5 2

♦ T 8 4 3 2

♣ 8 4 2

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 8

NORTH needs to know how many Aces SOUTH holds.

One way to find out would be to bid 3♠, (which is forcing), then launch Blackwood.

Another way is to bid 4♣ (Gerber) right now.

The first way is probably better but we needed a Gerber example.

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by South			

Deal 9

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 9
♥ J T 8 6
♦ Q J T 8 4
♣ T 8 3

25
4 4
7

♠ A J T 5
♥ A K
♦ K 5
♣ A K Q J 4



♠ K Q 8 7 4 3
♥ Q 7 5
♦ -
♣ 9 7 6 2

♠ 6 2
♥ 9 4 3 2
♦ A 9 7 6 3 2
♣ 5

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♦
Pass	7♠		
All Pass			
7♠ by South void!			

.

NORTH readjusts her thinking and decides to bid the Grand.

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 9

SOUTH's positive response shows 8+ points and five or more cards headed by at least two honors.

NORTH figures a small slam would be safe, but just to be sure she uses Blackwood.

SOUTH's 6

♦

reply shows one Key-card which must be the trump King,

and a

♦

Deal 10

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ T 8 4
♥ 4
♦ J 8 7 5 2
♣ A T 5 2

17
5 3
15

♠ K Q 3
♥ K T 9 3
♦ A 6
♣ K Q 9 6



♠ A 6
♥ A Q 8 7 5 2
♦ K Q 3
♣ 8 7

♠ J 9 7 5 2
♥ J 6
♦ T 9 4
♣ J 4 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♠
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

That is enough for NORTH to bid the slam.

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 10

SOUTH jumps in



s, showing a good suit and slam interest.

NORTH has great



support so bids RKCB 4NT.

SOUTH responds 5♠, showing two Key Cards and the



Q.

Deal 11

North Deals
None Vul

♠ J 8
♥ J 9 7 5
♦ Q T 4
♣ T 8 7 2

23
4 1
12

♠ A Q 6 4
♥ A K Q
♦ A 5
♣ K J 6 3



♠ K T 7 5 3 2
♥ 8
♦ K 8 6
♣ A Q 4

♠ 9
♥ T 6 4 3 2
♦ J 9 7 3 2
♣ 9 5

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♣	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

7NT by South
should be enough for Grand Slam. He chooses 7NT.

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 11

When NORTH agrees to ♠s, SOUTH will not stop short of a slam.

The RKCB 4NT bid tells SOUTH that they have all five Key Cards since NORTH could hardly

have a 2♣ opening hand with no Aces.

SOUTH's 5



bid is the Queen Ask, and NORTH's reply confirms that she holds

the ♠Q, and also has the ♣K.

SOUTH figures the ♠ suit will run, and this

Deal 12

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 4 2
 ♥ A T 9 7 5 4
 ♦ 9 8
 ♣ 8 3

15
 5 3
 17

♠ Q 8 6
 ♥ Q J 3
 ♦ A J 5
 ♣ A J 6 5



♠ A K 7 5 3
 ♥ 8
 ♦ K Q 7 2
 ♣ K Q 4

♠ T 9
 ♥ K 6 2
 ♦ T 6 4 3
 ♣ T 9 7 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♠	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 12

SOUTH knows there are enough points for slam, but she is worried about the trump suit.

NORTH's support doesn't guarantee more than three ♠s, and if they are not headed

by the Queen she could lose a trump trick.

Her RKCB bid relieves her mind when SOUTH claims two Key Cards PLUS the ♠Q.

She bids 6♠ (and hopes for a 3-2 trump split!).

Deal 13

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4
 ♥ Q 4 3
 ♦ K J T 7 5
 ♣ T 7 2

14
 6 4
 16

♠ K 9 3
 ♥ A T 6
 ♦ A 9 8 6 2
 ♣ K 9



♠ A Q J 6 5 2
 ♥ K 8 2
 ♦ Q
 ♣ A 8 5

♠ T 8
 ♥ J 9 7 5
 ♦ 4 3
 ♣ Q J 6 4 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 13

When SOUTH makes a slam try with a jump to 3♠, the best approach for NORTH is to agree on

the trump suit immediately but indicate a minimum hand by bidding 4♠.

SOUTH's next move is logical; RKCB 4NT.

NORTH shows zero or three Key Cards, and since it could not possibly be zero, SOUTH knows they are

the ♠K and both red Aces. Even possessing all the Key Cards SOUTH knows there aren't

enough points for a Grand slam.

Deal 14

North Deals

None Vul

♠ T 8 7 6 3 2

♥ T

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ K J

7
5 5
23

♠ 9 5

♥ A K 9 8 7 4 2

♦ 7 3

♣ 8 7



♠ A K

♥ Q J 3

♦ A K Q 5

♣ A 9 6 2

♠ Q J 4

♥ 6 5

♦ T 9 8

♣ Q T 5 4 3

West

North

East

South

3♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♥

Pass

7NT

All Pass

7NT by South

SOUTH knows they are the

♥

A

♥

K

so she can count thirteen tricks.

She bids a confident 7NT (and hopes NORTH didn't open 3

♥

with a 6-card suit.

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 14

It is usually not recommended to use any form of Blackwood when you have a suit with two quick

losers, but SOUTH knows NORTH would not preempt with a 10-high

♥

suit.

NORTH's reply to RKCB is 5

♥

, showing two Key Cards.

Deal 15

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K
 ♥ J T 5 4
 ♦ J T 9 5 4
 ♣ 6 4 2

11
 5 4
 20

♠ J 9 6 4 3

♥ A Q 3

♦ Q 7

♣ Q 5 3



♠ Q T 8 7 5

♥ K 6

♦ A K 3

♣ A K J

♠ A 2
 ♥ 9 8 7 2
 ♦ 8 6 2
 ♣ T 9 8 7

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 15

SOUTH has 21 points, and when she hears NORTH make a limit raise she tries for slam with RKCB.

NORTH answers with just one Key Card so SOUTH stops at 5♠, knowing they are missing

two Key Cards.

Of course she didn't expect the two missing Key Cards to be the Ace and King of trumps!

West	North	East	South
			1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♠
All Pass			
5♠ by South			

Deal 16

South Deals
None Vul

♠ T 9 4 3
♥ 8 4 2
♦ J 9
♣ Q T 8 2

14
3 5
18

♠ K Q 5
♥ A Q 9 6
♦ 7 6 4
♣ K 9 6



♠ A J 6
♥ K 7 5
♦ K Q 5 3
♣ A J 5

♠ 8 7 2
♥ J T 3
♦ A T 8 2
♣ 7 4 3

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 16

What is this doing here in the RKCB Practice Pages?

To emphasize that there are many 4NT bids which are NOT asking for Aces.

In this case, SOUTH showed a balanced hand with 18 or 19 points, and NORTH invited him

to bid 6NT if he felt his hand was a "maximum". He didn't, so he passed.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			
4NT by South			

Deal 17

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 6 4 3
♥ 8
♦ A T 6
♣ K Q T 5 2

10
9 8
13

♠ A 9 7 2
♥ Q J 5 3
♦ Q J 7 5 3
♣ -



♠ K 5
♥ A K 9 7 6 2
♦ K 8
♣ 7 6 4

♠ Q J T
♥ T 4
♦ 9 4 2
♣ A J 9 8 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	4 ♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	6 ♣	Pass	6 ♥
All Pass			
6 ♥ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 17

When NORTH makes a Splinter bid, showing



support and ♣ shortness,

SOUTH naturally thinks about slam.

She uses RKCB 4NT, and NORTH, with one Key Card and a ♣ Void, bids 6 ♣.

Just what SOUTH needed for the 6



bid.

Deal 18

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 4
♥ 8 7 6 2
♦ 9 7 3 2
♣ A 9 6 3

17
4 3
16

♠ A K 6 3
♥ K Q T 4
♦ K Q 8 5
♣ 2



♠ Q 9 8 2
♥ A 9 5
♦ A 6 4
♣ K Q J

♠ J T 7 5
♥ J 3
♦ J T
♣ T 8 7 5 4

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 18

NORTH thinks they should be in slam, and uses Stayman to check for a 4-4 Major fit.

When SOUTH announces four ♠s NORTH uses RKCB 4NT.

SOUTH's 5♠ bid shows two Key Cards plus the ♠Q.

This fills the holes in NORTH's hand nicely, so she bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♠
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by South			

Deal 19

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 7 5 4

♥ J 8 6

♦ T 9 3

♣ T 5 4

17
3 4
16

♠ A K 6 3

♥ K Q T 4

♦ K Q 8 5

♣ 2



♠ J 9 8 2

♥ A 9 5

♦ A J 4

♣ K Q J

♠ T

♥ 7 3 2

♦ 7 6 2

♣ A 9 8 7 6 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♠

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♥

Pass

5♠

All Pass

5♠ by South

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 19

This is the companion hand to Deal 18.

Again, NORTH uses RKCB after the 4-4 ♠ fit is discovered.

This time SOUTH shows two Key Cards without the ♠Q.

Now NORTH realizes that in addition to one outside Ace, there is a very possible loser

in trumps. So she stops at 5♠.

Deal 20

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 8 6
♥ -
♦ J T 9 4 2
♣ Q T 6 3

9
6 6
19

♠ 7 3 2
♥ A K Q 8 6 4
♦ 5 3
♣ 8 7



♠ A K 4
♥ J 9 5
♦ A K 7 6
♣ A 5 4

♠ T 9 5
♥ T 7 3 2
♦ Q 8
♣ K J 9 2

West

Pass

All Pass

3NT by South

North

2♥

3NT

East

Pass

South

2NT

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 20

The chances of a slam on this hand are very small, and if SOUTH decides to use RKCB it will

just confuse matters when NORTH shows two Key Cards.

SOUTH has a better way to find out about the hand. She bids 2NT asking NORTH to further describe

this hand. NORTH should then bid 3NT, showing a solid suit headed by AKQ.

NORTH cannot have as much as an extra Jack, so SOUTH just passes 3NT.

Deal 21

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ -
 ♥ 8 4
 ♦ A T 7 6 2
 ♣ J 9 8 7 3 2

7
 5 6
 22

♠ K 5 3
 ♥ A 9 5 2
 ♦ 8 5 4
 ♣ 6 5 4



♠ A Q J 8 6 2
 ♥ K Q 7
 ♦ K Q J
 ♣ A

♠ T 9 7 4
 ♥ J T 6 3
 ♦ 9 3
 ♣ K Q T

West	North	East	South
			2 ♣
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♥	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 21

SOUTH realizes NORTH has fewer than 8 points, but the 3 ♠ support bid is enough

for her to try a RKCB 4NT bid.

NORTH shows two Key Cards and SOUTH figures they will be the ♠K and one of the

red Aces. So she bids 6 ♠. If instead the Key Cards are the two red Aces SOUTH

might possibly make all thirteen tricks with a finesse.

Deal 22

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 4
♥ J T 9 3
♦ A Q 7 4 3
♣ T 7 6

6
7 5
22

♠ A 7 2
♥ Q 7 4
♦ 9 8 5
♣ 9 8 4 3

N
W E
S

♠ K Q J 5
♥ A K 6 5 2
♦ 6
♣ A K Q

♠ T 9 8 6 3
♥ 8
♦ K J T 2
♣ J 5 2

West	North	East	South
			2 ♣
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♣	Pass	5 ♦
Pass	6 ♥		
All Pass			

6 ♥ by South
, the Queen Ask.

NORTH has the

♥

Q but no King so she jumps

to 6

♥

.

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 22
NORTH's 3

♥

bid is "encouraging" so SOUTH bids 4NT.

When NORTH shows one Key Card, (an Ace),
SOUTH is afraid he may have a trump loser as
well the

other Ace. To find out about the

♥

Q he

bids 5

♦

Deal 23

South Deals
None Vul

♠ T 8 6
♥ Q T
♦ A Q T 9 3
♣ 7 6 2

5
8 5
22

♠ A 7 2
♥ J 9 8 7 4
♦ 8 5
♣ 8 4 3



♠ K Q J 5
♥ A K 6 5 2
♦ 6
♣ A K Q

♠ 9 4 3
♥ 3
♦ K J 7 4 2
♣ J T 9 5

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♦
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South to 6			



anyway.

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 23

This is the companion to Deal 22.

Again, worried about a possible trump loser in addition to the missing Ace, SOUTH

bids 5



, the Queen Ask.

NORTH definitely does NOT have the



Q. But with five trumps she

does know that SOUTH probably does not have a trump loser so she jumps

Deal 24

South Deals
None Vul

♠ J
♥ T 3
♦ J 9 8 6 5
♣ Q T 7 4 3

17
4 7
12

♠ A K 9 6 3
♥ A J 7 5
♦ K Q 2
♣ 6



♠ 8 5
♥ K Q 9 6 4
♦ 7 3
♣ A K 8 5

♠ Q T 7 4 2
♥ 8 2
♦ A T 4
♣ J 9 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♣
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♠
Pass	6 ♥		
All Pass			
6 ♥ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set8 24

NORTH cannot use RKCB at her second bid because trumps have not been agreed. So she bids

3



to set trumps, knowing SOUTH cannot pass after her jump-shift.

SOUTH tries to stop at game but NORTH is too strong so she now uses RKCB and gets

to 6



when SOUTH shows two Key Cards and the trump Queen.